

Business Plan – Handy & HandyChat

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1. Executive Summary

Handy & **HandyChat** is a digital assistant created to support international students at Zhejiang Normal University (ZJNU).

It solves the biggest challenges students face by providing:

- Clear and accurate **PE** class information
- Easy access to the university **handbook**
- A simple interface for common questions
- A bilingual AI chatbot available **24/7**

By combining a clean web platform (**Handy**) with an AI-powered chatbot (**HandyChat**), the system reduces confusion, improves communication, and significantly decreases the repetitive workload placed on staff and student volunteers each semester.

2. Problem Statement

International students experience the same challenges every semester. These issues slow them down, confuse them, and create unnecessary stress – not because information doesn't exist, but because it's difficult to access when students need it most.

✗ Information is scattered across too many places

- Locations, PE requirements, rules and regulations, and general campus knowledge are spread across many disconnected sources – paper handbooks, old PDF files, random group chats, and student rumors.
Students struggle to find clear answers and often rely on asking others, which can lead to incomplete or incorrect information.

✗ Students must physically walk around campus to find PE classes

- At the start of the semester, students walk between every sports center trying to locate their classes.
If they ask for help, they may receive different answers from different volunteers or students.
This wastes time, causes frustration, and makes students feel lost.
In some cases, students even lose motivation to attend the class.

✗ Repetitive work for staff

- Volunteers (such as the Shining Team) and administrative offices answer the same questions over and over.
This creates a heavy workload and slows down response times.

✗ Rules and regulations are hard to access or understand

- The paper handbook is widely available because it is given to every student – but almost nobody reads it. Even those who try find that it is:
 - Too long
 - Difficult to search
 - Not friendly for quick reference
 - Written in formal administrative language

As a result, students prefer asking someone instead of reading the handbook.

“ ✨ Result

Waste time, get misinformed, walk around campus confused, and feel unsupported – not because the university lacks resources, but because **the information delivery system is outdated and disconnected.**

From many students' experiences

”

3. Proposed Solution

Handy & HandyChat modernize the entire experience by offering **one place**, available anytime, where students can get reliable answers instantly.

✓ **Handy (Web App)**

A clean, simple platform that provides:

- Centralized PE class information
- PE running rules and requirements
- Facility and sports location details (with **photos/maps**)
- Frequently Asked Questions
- Important campus guidance
- Direct access to the **HandyChat** assistant
- Information about student support teams like the Shining Team

Students can access essential information with one click.

✓ **HandyChat (AI Chatbot)**

A bilingual assistant powered by GPT-4o-mini that:

- Answers questions in English and Chinese
- Understands natural language
- Retrieves accurate PE class information
- Searches handbook knowledge base
- Avoids misinformation
- Works 24/7

This reduces pressure on university staff and student volunteers.

4. Target Users

🎯 **Primary Users**

- International students at ZJNU
 - Freshmen arriving for orientation
 - Students taking PE classes
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5. Market Opportunity

ZJNU has a large and diverse **international community**.

As the number of students grows, the demand for:

- Clear information

- Bilingual communication
- Digital support tools

increases.

Currently, no single system offers:

- AI-driven answers
- Bilingual support
- PE + handbook integration
- A unified student information platform

This creates a strong opportunity for Handy & HandyChat to become the first official digital assistant for international students at ZJNU.

6. Value Proposition

For Students

- Instant answers
- No more walking around searching for PE classes
- Clear understanding of rules and processes
- Bilingual support (English/Chinese)
- A simple guide for everyday campus needs

For Staff & Volunteers

- Fewer repetitive questions
- More time for complex cases
- Better communication with large groups
- Less confusion during the semester

For ZJNU

- A modern digital service
 - Stronger international student experience
 - A scalable platform for future campus features
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7. Sustainability

The project is simple and inexpensive to maintain, making it practical for **long-term** use at ZJNU:

- Only small updates are required each semester (new PE classes, updated rules).
- The backend and database are lightweight and can run on basic university servers.
- Maintenance can be handled by CST student volunteers, internship students, or the Shining Team.

- The system does not rely on complex infrastructure, so future improvements can be added gradually.

This ensures Handy & HandyChat can continue supporting international students without placing a heavy burden on the university.

8. Competitive Analysis

Feature	Current ZJNU Tools	Handy & HandyChat
PE class map	✗ Limited	✓ Full integration
Handbook search	✗ Only paper/PDF	✓ AI-powered search
Bilingual support	✗ Limited	✓ English + Chinese
Availability	✗ No	✓ 24/7

9. Go-to-Market Strategy

Phase 1 — MVP (Hackathon Version)

- Core chatbot
- PE information system
- Handbook search features
- Minimal UI

Phase 2 — Pilot Testing

- Launch to a small student group
- Collect feedback
- Improve UI and accuracy

Phase 3 — Full Deployment

- Introduce to all international students
- Add more features
- Expand PE classes + handbook sections

Phase 4 — University-Wide Assistant

- More sections
- Dormitory services
- Course selection help

- Academic support
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10. Risk Assessment

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
AI misunderstanding	Medium	Fallback-first answers, simple checks
Outdated information	High	Assign update team each semester
Overuse of API	Medium	Optimize requests, caching
Misuse or spam	Low	Add content filters

11. Future Development

Handy & HandyChat can evolve into a complete student assistant:

- Full campus map navigation
 - Multi-language support (Arabic, French, etc.)
 - Mobile app or WeChat mini-program
 - Admin dashboard for staff
 - Real-time push notifications
 - Voice-enabled chatbot
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12. Conclusion

Handy & HandyChat directly address the real challenges faced by international students at ZJNU.

By providing a centralized, bilingual, AI-powered solution, the project:

- Reduces confusion
- Saves time
- Improves communication
- Modernizes student support services

With strong scalability and low-cost maintenance, this assistant has real potential to become an official tool used across the university.

